

WNBA Portfolio Analysis: Round 1 Investment Report

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Subject: Investment Portfolio for Las Vegas Aces @ Indiana Fever

Constraint Acknowledgment: This analysis and the resulting investment portfolio are constructed in strict adherence to the provided list of wagers and odds. All selections are drawn exclusively from the "Bets for Analysis" list, and no external or alternative markets have been considered. This constraint is confirmed and will be followed without deviation.

Executive Summary & Final Portfolio

This report outlines the investment strategy for Round 1, focusing on the matchup between the Las Vegas Aces and the Indiana Fever. The portfolio is constructed based on a rigorous, quantitative analysis designed to identify and exploit market inefficiencies, with the ultimate goal of maximizing long-term percentage profit.

The primary analytical narrative centers on the market's failure to accurately price the confluence of three critical factors: 1) The severe offensive degradation of the Indiana Fever due to the confirmed absence of superstar Caitlin Clark, a variable that fundamentally alters the team's offensive identity and efficiency ¹; 2) The systemic underperformance of the Las Vegas Aces in road games, compounded by a disadvantageous scheduling position that precedes a matchup with the league-leading Minnesota Lynx ²; and 3) The predictable and quantifiable shift in offensive usage toward Indiana's remaining All-Star, Aliyah Boston, whose role will expand significantly.⁴

The portfolio strategy is balanced, allocating the most significant capital toward the most profoundly mispriced lines, which are the game total and the player proposition market involving Aliyah Boston. A secondary, substantial allocation is directed toward the Indiana Fever moneyline, which captures the full value of a projected outright home victory against a vulnerable road opponent. A final, smaller allocation is made to

a high-variance, high-payout proposition bet that demonstrates positive expected value based on probabilistic modeling. This diversified yet focused approach aims to secure a profitable return for Round 1 while preserving capital for the long-term competition.

Final Portfolio: Round 1

The following is the ranked list of selected investments, with allocations totaling the \$5.00 bankroll.

1. Aliyah Boston to Score More Points Than Jackie Young

- **Bet Description:** Aliyah Boston v Jackie Young - More Points: Aliyah Boston (-115)
 - **Allocated Bet Amount:** \$1.75
 - **Profit Potential Rationale (The "Why"):** This wager is predicated on a quantifiable shift in offensive hierarchy for the Indiana Fever. With Caitlin Clark and her 31.1% usage rate absent, Aliyah Boston, the team's most efficient scorer (TS%=.612, PER=24.4), is the logical primary beneficiary.⁴ A conservative projection elevates Boston's usage rate from 21.4% to approximately 27-28%, which, combined with her superior efficiency compared to Jackie Young (TS%=.559), should translate into a scoring output well above her season average of 15.5 PPG.⁷ This situational inflation of Boston's role creates a significant value discrepancy against the market odds.
 - **Primary Risk / Counter-Argument:** The primary risk is that the vacated usage from Clark is distributed more evenly among other players like Kelsey Mitchell, or that the Aces' defense, led by A'ja Wilson, successfully neutralizes Boston in the post.
 - **Confidence & Allocation Justification (1-5):** 5. The data supporting an increased usage rate for a team's most efficient interior player in the absence of a high-volume perimeter star is fundamentally sound and highly reliable. The significant gap in True Shooting Percentage between Boston and Young provides a strong efficiency buffer, making this the highest-confidence bet in the portfolio, warranting the largest allocation.
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2. Game Total Under 164.5

- **Bet Description:** Total: Under 164.5 (-108)
 - **Allocated Bet Amount:** \$1.50
 - **Profit Potential Rationale (The "Why"):** The market total of 164.5 appears to be anchored to the Fever's season-long offensive metrics, which are rendered obsolete by Caitlin Clark's absence. Indiana's 3rd-ranked Offensive Rating (107.4) is heavily influenced by Clark's presence; without her, a regression toward the league average is expected, with models projecting an adjusted ORtg closer to 102.0.⁹ Combining this adjusted rating with the Aces' mediocre offense (103.5 ORtg) and a likely decrease in pace projects a final score in the 159-160 point range, creating a substantial 4.5 to 5.5-point cushion for the under.
 - **Primary Risk / Counter-Argument:** The risk is that both teams play with uncharacteristically high offensive efficiency, or that the game's fast pace (both teams rank in the top 7) leads to enough possessions to overcome Indiana's offensive downgrade.⁹
 - **Confidence & Allocation Justification (1-5):** 4. The statistical case for the under is robust and based on the single most impactful variable in the game: Clark's injury. The projected point total is significantly lower than the market line, indicating a strong edge. The allocation is substantial, reflecting high confidence in the model's adjustment for the injury's impact on scoring environment.
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3. Indiana Fever Moneyline

- **Bet Description:** Moneyline: IND Fever (+110)
- **Allocated Bet Amount:** \$1.25
- **Profit Potential Rationale (The "Why"):** This bet capitalizes on the market overvaluing the Las Vegas Aces in a difficult situational spot. The Aces possess a losing road record (5-7) and a negative net rating (-1.0) for the season, profiling them as a distinctly average team away from home.² This matchup is also the front end of a demanding back-to-back that concludes against the league-best Minnesota Lynx, creating a potential "look-ahead" scenario.³ The Fever, despite being without Clark, are a competent 7-6 at home and have already defeated the Aces decisively in this venue, 81-54 on July 3.²
- **Primary Risk / Counter-Argument:** The primary risk is that the talent of A'ja Wilson and the Aces proves too much for a Fever team whose offense may stall without its primary playmaker, allowing Las Vegas to win on talent alone despite the situational disadvantages.
- **Confidence & Allocation Justification (1-5):** 4. The confluence of the Aces' poor road performance, the difficult scheduling spot, and the Fever's proven

ability to win this matchup at home creates a clear value proposition at plus-money odds. The model projects Indiana as a small favorite, making the +110 price a significant +EV opportunity. The allocation reflects strong confidence in these well-supported situational and historical factors.

4. Aliyah Boston to be the First Points Scorer

- **Bet Description:** First Points Scorer: Aliyah Boston (+550)
- **Allocated Bet Amount:** \$0.50
- **Profit Potential Rationale (The "Why"):** This is a calculated, small-unit investment in a high-variance market where the odds misrepresent the underlying probability. Aliyah Boston is one of two players, along with A'ja Wilson, who will contest the opening tip-off, granting her team a roughly 50% chance at the first possession. As the undisputed offensive focal point for Indiana without Clark, the probability of the first offensive set being designed for her is exceptionally high. Her true probability of scoring first is likely closer to 20-25%, far exceeding the 15.4% implied probability of the +550 odds.
- **Primary Risk / Counter-Argument:** The primary risks are that A'ja Wilson wins the tip and scores first for the Aces, or that Indiana wins the tip but another player, such as Kelsey Mitchell, takes and makes the first shot.
- **Confidence & Allocation Justification (1-5):** 2. While the bet has a clear positive expected value, the outcome is subject to high variance (the result of a single possession). The confidence score reflects the analytical edge, but the low probability of the event itself dictates a small, strategic allocation. This bet is a classic example of a +EV wager that should be made consistently in small sizes over the long term.

Comprehensive Game Environment Analysis

Advanced Statistical Profile: A Tale of Two Mid-Tier Teams

An objective, season-long statistical analysis reveals that this matchup is not between a reigning powerhouse and a struggling upstart, but rather between two teams

occupying the league's competitive middle ground. The Las Vegas Aces, despite their championship pedigree, have posted metrics that align with a .500 team. They rank 8th in Offensive Rating (ORTg=103.5) and a concerning 9th in Defensive Rating (DRtg=104.5), resulting in a negative Net Rating of -1.0, 8th best in the WNBA.³ This data paints a clear picture of a team that has underperformed expectations throughout the 2025 season.

Conversely, the Indiana Fever's baseline statistics appear superior. They boast the league's 3rd-ranked offense (ORTg=107.4) and a 7th-ranked defense (DRtg=103.2), culminating in a strong 5th-place Net Rating of +4.2.⁹ However, as will be detailed extensively, this top-line number is a statistical illusion, skewed by the presence of a generational talent who will not be on the court for this contest.

In terms of game flow, both teams favor an up-tempo style. The Fever rank 4th in the league in Pace (78.4 possessions per 48 minutes), while the Aces are close behind at 7th (78.2).⁹ This shared preference for a faster game suggests a high number of possessions, a factor that typically correlates with higher-scoring outcomes. From an efficiency standpoint, the Fever have held a notable edge, ranking 5th in True Shooting Percentage (

TS%=.552) compared to the Aces' 8th-place mark of .535.⁹

Table 1: Comparative Team Advanced Metrics (2025 Season)

Metric	Las Vegas Aces (Rank)	Indiana Fever (Rank)
Offensive Rating	103.5 (8th)	107.4 (3rd)
Defensive Rating	104.5 (9th)	103.2 (7th)
Net Rating	-1.0 (8th)	+4.2 (5th)
Pace	78.2 (7th)	78.4 (4th)
True Shooting %	.535 (8th)	.552 (5th)
Data sourced from. ⁹		

This table consolidates the foundational data, establishing the unadjusted statistical

identities of both teams. It serves as the baseline from which all crucial contextual and injury-related adjustments are made, thereby quantifying the value present in the market.

Contextual Overlays: The Situational Disadvantage for Las Vegas

Beyond season-long averages, situational factors heavily influence game outcomes. In this matchup, these factors create a significant headwind for the Las Vegas Aces. A pronounced home/away dichotomy is evident in their performance; the Aces' mediocrity is amplified on the road, where they have compiled a losing 5-7 record.² In stark contrast, the Indiana Fever have proven to be a formidable opponent in their own building, holding a 7-6 record at Gainbridge Fieldhouse.² This performance gap suggests that a standard home-court advantage adjustment may even understate Indiana's edge in this specific context.

The head-to-head history this season reinforces this location-based performance narrative. The teams have split their two meetings, with each franchise securing a dominant victory on its home floor.¹² The Fever's 81-54 demolition of the Aces in Indiana on July 3 is particularly instructive, as it demonstrates their capacity to control and win this matchup decisively in this venue.¹⁰

Perhaps the most critical, and potentially overlooked, contextual factor is the Aces' grueling schedule. This game is not an isolated road trip; it is the first leg of a difficult back-to-back that concludes the following night in Minnesota against the WNBA's best team, the 21-4 Lynx.³ This creates what is known in analytical circles as a "look-ahead" spot, a scenario where a team's focus and energy may be partially directed toward a more significant upcoming opponent. This scheduling disadvantage serves as a further downgrade to the Aces' projected performance level. While Las Vegas enters on a three-game winning streak, this is largely neutralized by the fact those wins came at home, whereas Indiana's concurrent two-game skid occurred on the road against the elite New York Liberty.²

The Caitlin Clark Variable: Quantifying a Superstar's Absence

The single most impactful variable for this contest is the confirmed absence of Indiana Fever guard Caitlin Clark, who will miss her 13th game of the season with a right groin injury for which there is no return timetable.¹ Clark is the undisputed engine of the Fever's offense, leading the team in assists (8.8 per game) and commanding a massive 31.1% usage rate when on the floor.⁵ Her absence removes not just a scorer but the team's primary offensive initiator and playmaker, forcing a fundamental restructuring of their half-court sets.

This necessitates a significant downward adjustment to Indiana's offensive projections. Their season-long Offensive Rating of 107.4, which ranks 3rd in the WNBA, is a composite figure heavily inflated by the 12 games Clark has played.¹ To create an accurate projection for this specific game, it is necessary to model the Fever's offense without her. A player of her statistical magnitude is irreplaceable. A conservative but analytically sound approach involves regressing their offensive efficiency toward the league average. A projected drop of approximately 5.4 points in their offensive rating, to a modeled figure of

102.0, is a logical adjustment. This recalibration transforms the Fever from a top-tier offensive unit into a below-average one for this game, on par with the Golden State Valkyries (102.3 ORtg).⁹ This adjustment is the cornerstone of the portfolio's strategy, creating value across multiple betting markets.

Market-Specific Value Identification

Primary Market Analysis (Spread, Total, Moneyline)

With a properly adjusted statistical baseline, a direct comparison to the provided market lines reveals several significant pricing inefficiencies.

The **Game Total of 164.5** appears markedly inflated. A projection based on the unadjusted, season-long offensive ratings would yield a total of approximately 165.1 points. However, when applying the crucial adjustment for Clark's absence and modeling the Fever with a 102.0 Offensive Rating, the projected total plummets to

160.9 points. This calculation is derived by averaging the two teams' adjusted offensive ratings and multiplying by the projected pace: $((102.0 + 103.5) / 100) * 78.3 = 160.88$. Furthermore, the loss of a primary ball-handler often leads to a more deliberate offensive pace, suggesting the 78.3 possession projection is a ceiling. This provides a substantial 4.5 to 5.5-point edge on the **Under 164.5 (-108)**, making it a high-value investment.

The **Point Spread (LV Aces -2) and Moneyline (IND Fever +110)** also present a clear value discrepancy. The market line implies that the Aces are approximately 4.5 to 5.0 points superior to the Fever on a neutral court. This assessment is fundamentally flawed. After adjusting Indiana's net rating for Clark's absence (regressing it from +4.2 to approximately 0.0), the two teams are nearly identical in baseline quality (LVA Net Rating is -1.0).⁹ Factoring in a standard +2.5 points for Indiana's home-court advantage and a -1.0 point penalty for the Aces' difficult scheduling spot, the model projects a final line of

Indiana -3.5. This reveals a massive 5.5-point disagreement with the market's line of Aces -2. Both the **IND +2 (-112)** and **IND ML (+110)** wagers hold significant positive expected value. The moneyline at plus-odds is the superior investment, as it fully captures the value of a projected outright victory.

Player Proposition Deep Dive: Aliyah Boston vs. Jackie Young

The player proposition market asking who will score more points between Aliyah Boston and Jackie Young offers the portfolio's most compelling investment. On the surface, the players appear evenly matched, with Young averaging 16.7 PPG and Boston averaging 15.5 PPG.⁷ However, this matchup is defined by the dramatic shift in offensive context for Boston.

The 31.1% usage rate vacated by Caitlin Clark must be redistributed among the remaining players.⁵ As the team's most efficient and decorated interior player—boasting a 24.4 PER and a stellar.612 True Shooting Percentage—Boston is the most logical candidate to absorb a significant portion of that offensive responsibility.⁴ A reasonable projection would see her usage rate climb from its current 21.4% into the 27-28% range for this contest. Given her elite efficiency, this increase in volume should directly translate to an increased scoring output, pushing her projection for this game into the 18-20 point range. Jackie Young's role for the Aces remains static,

with her usage rate expected to hold near its 26.5% average.¹⁷ The -115 odds on Boston imply a 53.5% probability of her outscoring Young. The situational analysis suggests her true probability is considerably higher, creating a clear and actionable edge.

Table 2: Player Prop Analysis - Boston vs. Young

Player	PPG	Usage Rate (USG%)	Projected USG% (Game)	True Shooting % (TS%)	
Aliyah Boston	15.5	21.4%	~27.5%	.612	
Jackie Young	16.7	26.5%	26.5%	.559	
Data sourced from. ⁴					

First Scorer Probability Assessment

The "First Points Scorer" market is inherently high-variance, but a probabilistic approach can identify value. The first possession is determined by the opening tip-off, which will feature the teams' starting centers: A'ja Wilson for Las Vegas and Aliyah Boston for Indiana. This immediately narrows the field of most likely candidates to the two players who will physically control the game's start.

Both players are also their teams' primary offensive weapons. Wilson leads the Aces with a 30.8% usage rate, and the team's opening offensive sets are frequently designed to get her an early touch.¹⁸ For Indiana, Boston's role as the offensive centerpiece is magnified exponentially without Clark on the floor. Therefore, regardless of which team wins the tip, there is a high probability that the first shot attempt will come from one of these two players.

The odds for Wilson are +330 (23.3% implied probability), while Boston is priced at +550 (15.4% implied probability). Given that Boston is at home, directly involved in the

tip, and will be the undisputed offensive focus for her team, her true probability of scoring first is much closer to Wilson's. A more accurate estimate of Boston's probability is in the 20-25% range. Comparing this modeled probability to the market's implied probability of 15.4% reveals a clear positive expected value on the **Aliyah Boston (+550)** wager. While the outcome is far from certain, the price offers a compelling risk-reward scenario for a small, strategic investment.

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